

01 SMALL TALK

Do you reply to messages fast, or do you take your time?

Did anyone do something nice for you this week?

Do you say hi first to new people, or do you wait for them?

02 POP QUIZ — DOES THIS SOUND NATURAL?

① ~~"I have a lot of stress."~~

✓ "I'm really stressed out."

상태는 형용사 stressed로 말해요. have stress는 명사를 직역한 콩글리시예요.

② ~~"My hobby is watching Netflix."~~

✓ "I watch a lot of Netflix in my free time."

My hobby is~는 교과서처럼 딱딱해요. 자연스럽게 풀어서 말해요.

③ ~~"I want to healing this weekend."~~

✓ "I want to relax and recharge this weekend."

healing은 한국식 명사 사용이에요. heal은 상처가 낫다는 뜻이라 의미가 안 맞아요.

03 오늘의 워업

각자 1~4위로 순위 매기고 1위만 말하기. 다른 사람 의견 들으며 자기 순위 한 번 더 정리.

WARM-UP

Rank Them (5분)

1. Replying to messages in a soft, friendly tone
2. Helping a new person learn the things they don't know yet
3. Not blaming someone in front of others when they make a mistake
4. Checking how a tired or stressed coworker is feeling

WORK · MAIN DISCUSSION

Kindness at Work — Soft Skill or Basic Manners?

BACKGROUND

회사에서 다정함은 단순히 착한 성격이 아니라 같이 일하기 편한 태도처럼 보일 때가 있어요. 답장을 부드럽게 하거나, 새로 온 사람에게 필요한 정보를 알려주거나, 실수한 사람을 공개적으로 몰아붙이지 않는 작은 행동들이 팀 분위기를 바꿨어요. 하지만 친절이 지나치면 감정노동처럼 느껴지거나 선을 넘는 관심이 될 수도 있어요. 좋은 다정함은 상대를 편하게 해주되, 내 역할과 에너지를 무리하게 소모하지 않는 방식이에요.

READ BEFORE WE TALK

Kindness at work is not only about being nice. It can make teamwork smoother through small behaviors: clear messages, patient explanations, polite corrections, and noticing when someone is lost. These habits can become a real soft skill, because people remember who made work easier. But kindness has limits. If one person always absorbs emotions, fixes confusion, or softens every conflict, it can become exhausting. The line is between basic manners and emotional labor. A healthy workplace does not depend on one warm person carrying the mood. It builds systems where consideration is normal and boundaries are respected. And these work choices rarely stay inside the office — they affect your energy, your sleep, and your life after work too.

WORDS YOU MIGHT NEED

leave someone on read — 읽씹하다

own your mistake — 실수를 인정하다

read the room — 분위기를 살피다

go with the flow — 흐름에 맡기다

it goes a long way — 큰 도움이 돼요

set boundaries — 선을 긋다

TRY THESE PHRASES

*I'd say it's a real skill because staying kind under pressure isn't easy.**The way I see it, anyone can be polite, but real kindness takes effort.**In my case, it turns into emotional labor when I have to hide how I really feel.**Honestly, it gets tiring when I keep smiling even though I'm upset inside.*

EASY ENTRY

- 1 Are you more of a 'soften-every-message' person or a 'keep-it-short-and-clear' person when you reply to coworkers?
- 2 When was the last time you helped someone new at work feel less lost — and what did you actually do?
- 3 Quick — if you had to pick one small kindness from a coworker: a heads-up before a problem, a quick 'good job', or someone covering for you when you're slammed?
- 4 Picture this: a coworker just made a small mistake in the group chat, and everyone saw it. What would you do?

MAIN DISCUSSION

Q1. Is being kind at work a real skill, or just basic manners?

*I'd say it's a real skill because staying kind under pressure isn't easy.**The way I see it, anyone can be polite, but real kindness takes effort.*

Q2. When does being kind at work turn into emotional labor for you?

*In my case, it turns into emotional labor when I have to hide how I really feel.**Honestly, it gets tiring when I keep smiling even though I'm upset inside.*

Q3. Can someone be very direct and still feel kind? What's the trick?

*I'd say yes — the trick is being honest but soft in the way you say it.**It really comes down to your tone, not just your words.*

Q4. Would you rather work with someone very skilled, or someone easy to talk to?

*I lean more toward someone easy to talk to because work feels lighter that way.**Compared to skill, good communication matters more to me day to day.*

Q5. What small thing makes a coworker easy to work with?

*What helps me a lot is when a coworker replies quickly, even just 'got it.'**Most of the time, it's the small habits — like saying thank you — that make someone easy to work with.*